

HUM 2101: Sociology and Disaster Management

Cultural content and growth of capitalism and development of civilization

Lecture 6.1

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Culture

- Culture refers to the cumulative deposit of knowledge, experience, beliefs, values, attitudes, meanings, hierarchies, religion, notions of time, roles, spatial relations, concepts of the universe, and material objects and possessions acquired by a group of people in the course of generations through individual and group striving.
- Culture is the systems of knowledge shared by a relatively large group of people.



Culture is communication, communication is culture

Material Culture

- **Material culture** refers to the physical objects, resources, and spaces that people use to define their culture.
- These include homes, neighborhoods, cities, schools, churches, synagogues, temples, mosques, offices, factories and plants, tools, means of production, goods and products, stores, and so forth.



Non-Material Culture

- **Non-material culture** refers to the nonphysical ideas that people have about their culture, including beliefs, values, rules, norms, morals, language, organizations, and institutions.
- For instance, the non-material cultural concept of religion consists of a set of ideas and beliefs about God, worship, morals, and ethics.
- These beliefs, then, determine how the culture responds to its religious topics, issues, and events.

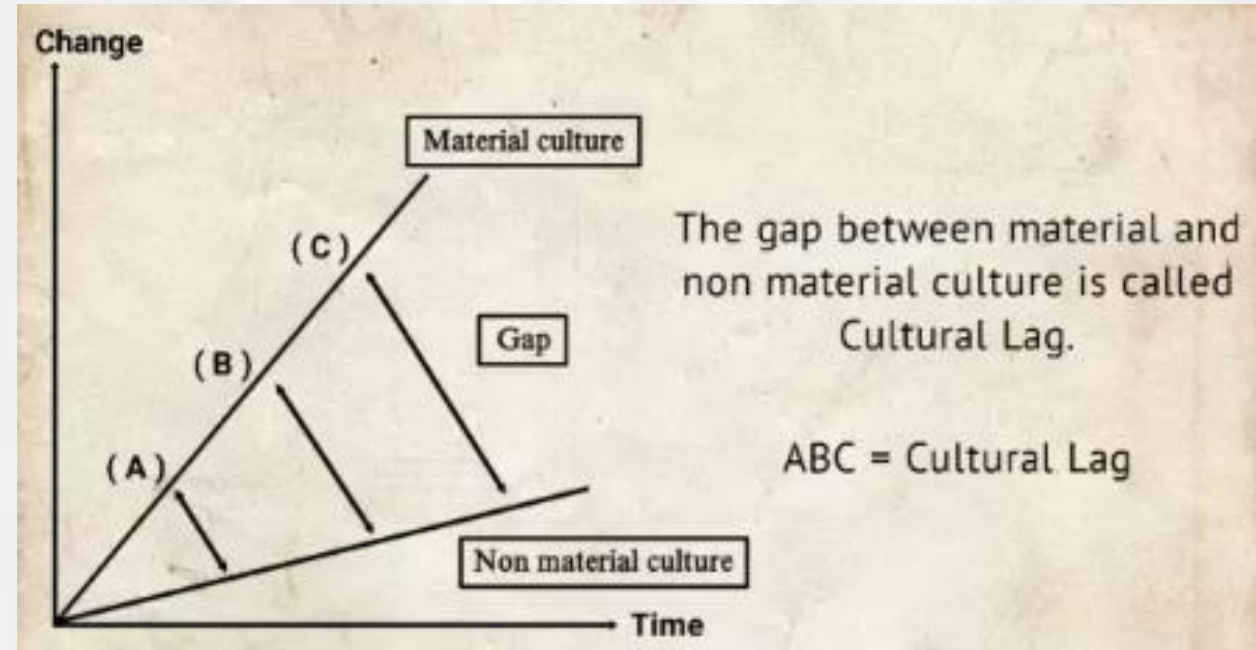


Differences between Material and Non-Material Culture

Material Culture	Non-Material Culture
A material culture places emphasis on objects, material accomplishments; the acquisition of material wealth; skill and productivity in arts and crafts; technology; fine buildings and displays of material prosperity.	A non-material culture values 'abstract/intangible' things more highly than objects, e.g. things such as ideas; the things of the mind; philosophy; metaphysics; 'spirituality'; values; beliefs; relationships between god and man; 'being', etc.
Material culture includes all of the physical objects that people create and give meaning to.	Non-material culture consists of thoughts and behavior that people learn as part of the culture they live in.
Material culture is what society actually does.	Non material culture is what society claims they do and believe in.
Tangible things.	Thoughts and ideas.
Examples: automobiles, books, buildings, clothing, computers and cooking.	Examples: beliefs, family, patterns, ideas, language, political and economic systems and rules.

Cultural Lag

- William Ogburn (sociologist)
- Cultural lag: slowness in the rate of change in one part of culture in relation to another (due to material invention/technological change)
- The change in one part of the cultural pattern may create strain and disturbances in closely related parts.



The gap between material culture and non material culture is known as Cultural Lag.

The term cultural lag refers to a situation where culture takes time to meet with technological innovations.

Civilization

Civilization relates to a 'complex society'

BUT WHEN ??????????????????

A society is complex when its individuals live in groups of 'settled dwellings comprising cities' and engage in specialized activities.



Elements of a complex society

- (1) Moral and legal systems to govern human conduct; to introduce justice
- (2) Advanced technology to fasten communication and produce consumer items, among others
- (3) Government to establish justice and protect individuals' rights
- (4) Food surplus to sustain the growing population
- (5) Culture



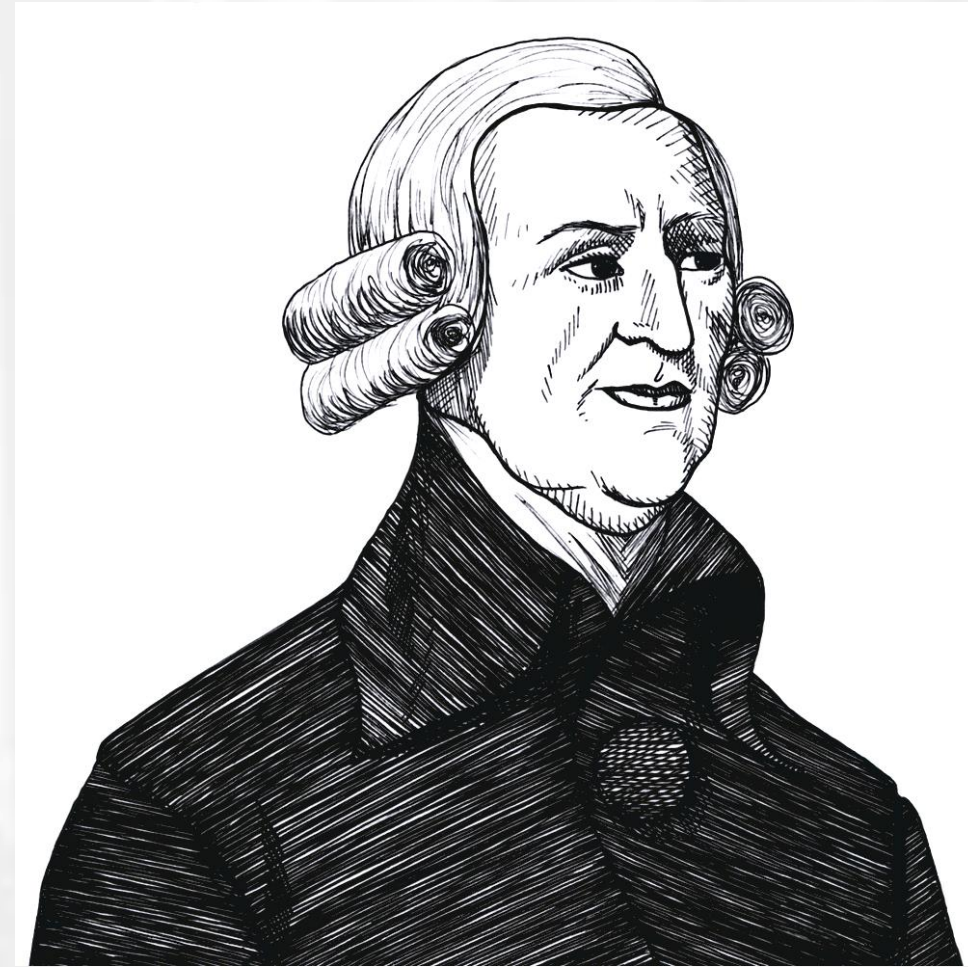
Growth of capitalism

Capitalism

An economic system in which private individuals are allowed to conduct their business for the purpose of individual gain and profit

Reasons for the growth of capitalism (1600-1700's)

1. Population growth and urbanization: more business opportunities and larger markets
2. Stable governments: protect private property



Adam Smith

- Adam Smith's ideas were well-timed, as the Industrial Revolution was starting to cause tremors that would soon shake the Western world.
- The gold mine of colonialism had brought new wealth and new demand for the products of domestic industries, which drove the expansion and mechanization of production.
- As technology leaped ahead and factories no longer had to be built near waterways or windmills to function, industrialists began building in the cities where there were now thousands of people to supply ready labor.
- Industrial tycoons were the first people to amass their wealth in their lifetimes, often outstripping both the landed nobles and many of the money lending/banking families.
- For the first time in history, common people could have hopes of becoming wealthy.
- The new money crowd built more factories that required more labor, while also producing more goods for people to purchase.

- During this period, the term "capitalism"—originating from the Latin word "capitalis," which means "head of cattle"—was first used by French socialist Louis Blanc in 1850,
 - to signify a system of exclusive ownership of industrial means of production by private individuals rather than shared ownership.



Louis Blanc

- ✓ Capitalism involved reorganizing society into social classes based not on ownership of land, but ownership of capital (i.e., businesses).
- ✓ Capitalists were able to earn profits from the surplus labor of the working class, who earned only wages.
- ✓ Thus, the two social classes defined by capitalism are the capitalists and the laboring classes.